

Video Editing

As a follow up to the December 2004 'Tips and Tricks' on audio editing, this month, we look at video editing.

One of the most popular video editing software available is Adobe Premiere Pro. A tryout version (30 days trial) of this is available in *Digit's* December 2004 DVD. VirtualDub is another option you could try. It's small, fast, and best of all, free! This freeware tool is popular and works well for basic requirements and can be found at www.virtualdub.org, or on the December 2004 *Digit* DVD and CD. VirtualDub also has many independent developers making plug-ins for it. For now, though, we will stick to Premiere Pro.

Once you get past the basics and are conversant with the software's interface, you will realise that basic editing is as easy as it can be. This article aims only to get you started on your video editing journey—even if we wrote a hundred pages of tips and tricks on video editing, we couldn't cover all the features. The tips and tricks mentioned here will range from the basic to the intermediate level.

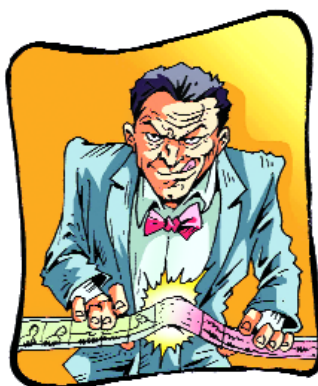
Hopefully, once you are done reading this article, you will not be intimidated

by the jargon, menus and myriad options that Premiere Pro throws at you.

Importing Files

The first thing you need to know is how to import files into Premiere Pro. Apart from standard video files (such as WMV, AVI and MOV files), you can also import images (BMP, JPG, GIF, EPS, PNG, PCT, TIFF, etc.), audio (MP3, WMA, AIF, etc.) and other formats such as layered PSD files and Adobe Illustrator art. If you are looking to import many

files, just place them all in one folder and simply import the folder.



Illustrations: Harsho Mohan Chatterjee

Tips & Tricks

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For starters, create a new project by going to File > New. Now you can select the type of output you desire in the box that pops up and click OK. A new project will open and you can now import your audio and video clips into it. To do this, go to File > Import, or press [Ctrl] + [I]. Use the 'Import Folder' option, if you need to import a folder containing audio and video clips.

Understanding The Interface

Before you start editing, you need to understand what all the different panes are and what they are used for. The screenshot below points out the various panes.

The Project pane: This is the pane where all files you import are displayed. Here, you can preview the clips and drag and position them in the 'Timeline Pane'.

The Monitor pane: This pane shows you a clip, your entire video sequence and add effects to them.

The Timeline pane: In this pane, you can place your audio and video clips, and edit them. You can cut clips and join them to other clips using this pane.

The Info pane: Here you see information about the selected clips.

The History pane: Information about all completed tasks is shown in this pane. You can use this

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The Info pane: Here you see information about the selected clips

The History pane: Here you see all the tasks you have completed. Use the History pane to make revisions and iron out mistakes